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Environmental Defense Fund

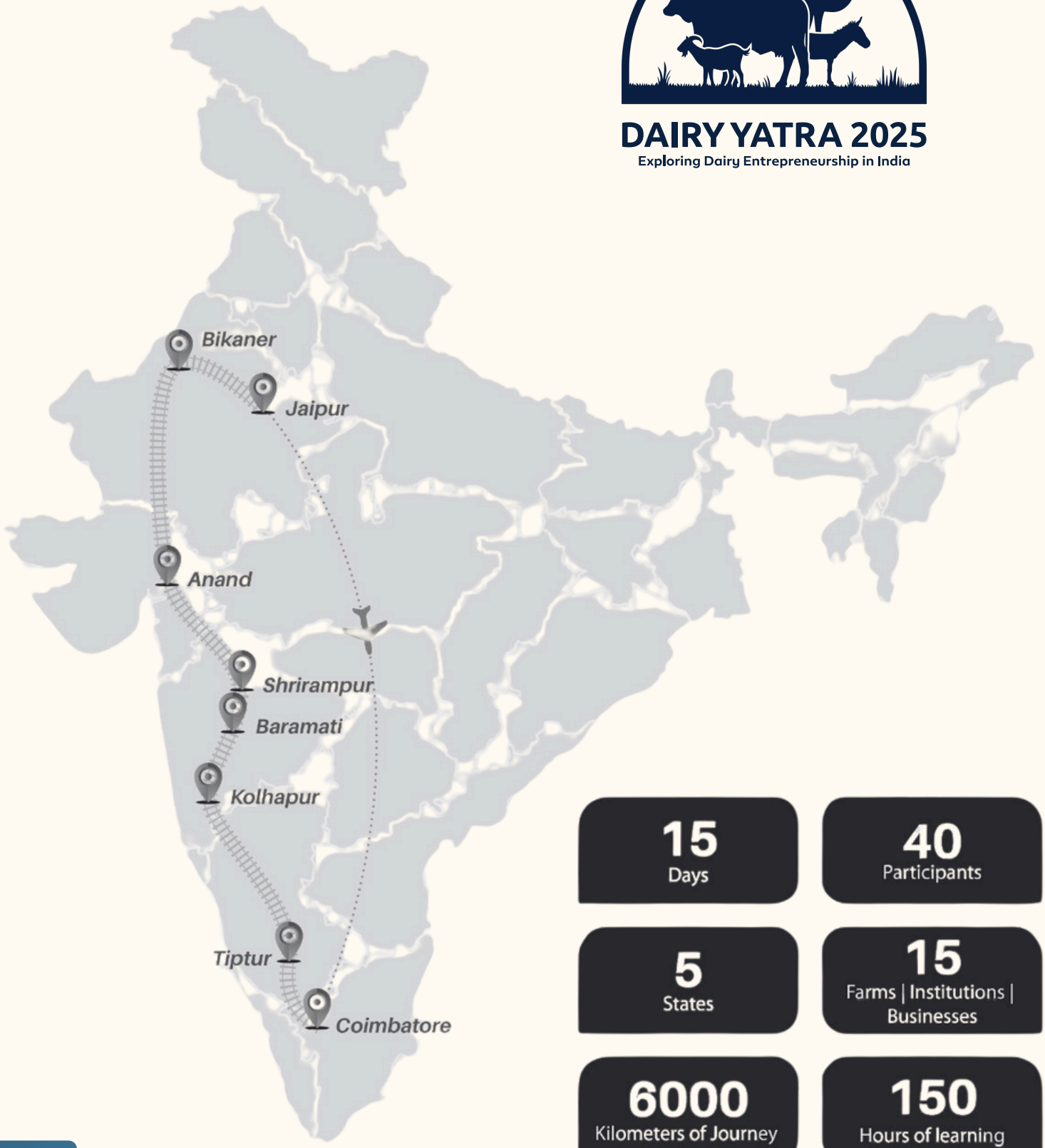
DAIRY YATRA 2025

Exploring Dairy Entrepreneurship in India



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15 Days

40 Participants

5 States

15 Farms | Institutions | Businesses

6000 Kilometers of Journey

150 Hours of learning

About Dairy Yatra 2025

Dairy Yatra 2025 is a groundbreaking 15-day travel program, bringing together 40 entrepreneurs to explore the dynamic dairy sector across five states of India. This first-ever experiential journey offers a unique opportunity to engage directly with farmers, visit dairy businesses, and discover innovative solutions that can enhance the productivity and profitability of dairy farming.

The program focuses on understanding the challenges faced by farmers and exploring business models that can address these needs. Participants will witness firsthand how advancements in technology, management practices, and sustainable farming methods can transform the dairy landscape. By meeting with industry leaders, entrepreneurs, and farmers, the group will gain valuable insights into improving milk production, processing, and distribution, all while focusing on profitability and growth.

Dairy Yatra 2025 aims to foster collaboration between farmers and entrepreneurs, creating a platform to share ideas, exchange knowledge, and build lasting partnerships. This immersive experience will help participants identify opportunities for innovation that can be scaled to improve the livelihoods of farmers across India.

Climate Smart Dairy Entrepreneurship Program

Kumaraguru Institutions, in collaboration with the Environmental Defense Fund, is launching an initiative to build an ecosystem and community for dairy entrepreneurs in Tamil Nadu. This program aims to empower rural youth, dairy entrepreneurs, and startups with essential technical knowledge, business expertise, and industry exposure. In turn, these entrepreneurs will provide affordable, high-quality inputs and climate-resilient advisory services to local dairy farmers.

The year-long program begins with an intensive three-month training module that covers scientific dairy farm management, entrepreneurial skills, and specific business competencies. Following the training, participants will benefit from nine months of mentorship, which will focus on key areas such as business strategy and planning, market research, technology and innovation, product development, networking with industry experts, and financial guidance.

Travel Plan

DAY	LOCATION	ORGANIZATIONS	LEARNING OBJECTIVES
1	Coimbatore, Tamil Nadu	Journey Begins	Set learning goals and expectations
2	Tiptur, Karnataka	Akshayakalpa Farm	Understand organic dairy farming and integrated models of dairy and vegetable production
3	Tiptur, Karnataka	BAIF Development Research Foundation	Explore innovative breed development and fodder development strategies
4	Kolhapur, Maharashtra	Travel & Cultural Immersion	Reflect on local culture and context in dairy practices
5	Kolhapur, Maharashtra	Businesses / Farms	Learn about Total Mixed Ration (TMR) production and its role in balanced feeding, learn buffalo farming
6	Baramati, Maharashtra	Centre of Excellence in Dairy	Examine integrated models for dairy production and training
7	Phaltan, Maharashtra	Govind Dairy	Gain insights into farmer empowerment initiatives including TMR, Hydroponics, Loose housing models
8	Shrirampur, Maharashtra	Prabhat Dairy	Understand value chain integration and market-oriented dairy enterprise (TMR, Breeding farms)
9	Anand, Gujarat	National Dairy Development Board	Explore NDDB's farmer support services and extension mechanisms, small scale processing unit efficiency
10	Anand, Gujarat	Mrida, NDDB	Understand manure management and value chain for sustainable dairying
11	Anand, Gujarat	Travel & Cultural Immersion	Observe regional practices and engage in reflective learning
12	Bikaner, Rajasthan	ICAR - NRCC on Camel	Learn about alternative dairy opportunities from camels and donkeys
13	Bikaner, Rajasthan	Saras Dairy	Explore drought-resilient dairy farming practices in arid zones
14	Jaipur, Rajasthan	Wrap-Up & Cultural Immersion	Synthesize key learnings and reflect on regional diversity in dairy
15	Coimbatore, Tamil Nadu	Return Journey	Consolidate experiences and plan for knowledge application

Host Organizations

Akshayakalpa Farm, Tiptur, Karnataka

The first stop will be at Akshayakalpa Farm in Tiptur, a leader in organic dairy farming. Known for its sustainable practices, Akshayakalpa focuses on chemical-free farming, ethical animal husbandry, and a direct farm-to-consumer model. Participants will see firsthand how organic milk production is transforming rural livelihoods and reducing environmental impact. They will also learn about innovative supply chain management and quality assurance techniques employed by the farm.

BAIF Institute for Sustainable Livelihoods and Development (BISLD), Karnataka

The next stop will be the BAIF Institute for Sustainable Livelihoods and Development (BISLD), a pioneer in rural development and sustainable livelihoods. At this institute, participants will explore BAIF's model of integrating dairy farming with rural empowerment, including livestock development, watershed management, and community-led initiatives. This visit will shed light on how dairy farming can boost rural economies and improve the lives of smallholder farmers.

TMR Plant of Gokul Dairy, Kolhapur, Maharashtra

The journey will continue to the TMR Plant of Gokul Dairy in Kolhapur, a centre of technological innovation in dairy processing. Participants will gain insights into Total Mixed Ration (TMR) technology, which optimizes cattle nutrition through a specialized feed management system. This visit will highlight how Gokul Dairy has contributed to the advancement of dairy processing techniques to meet the increasing demand for high-quality milk and dairy products across India.

Host Organizations

Centre of Excellence in Dairy, Baramati, Maharashtra

The Yatra will also include a visit to the Centre of Excellence in Dairy in Baramati, where participants will gain further insights into the latest research and best practices in dairy farming.

Amul Dairy, Anand

Amul Dairy, located in Anand, Gujarat, is India's leading dairy cooperative. Established in 1946, it revolutionized India's dairy industry through the White Revolution. Amul empowers millions of farmers by collecting and processing milk into high-quality dairy products. Its model promotes rural development, self-sufficiency, and innovation in the Indian dairy sector.

National Dairy Development Board (NDDB), Gujarat

National Dairy Development Board (NDDB) in Gujarat is one of India's leading institutions in dairy development, where participants will gain valuable insights. NDDB has played a crucial role in transforming the dairy sector through its cooperative model, empowering millions of farmers. This stop will highlight NDDB's contributions in cooperative management, policy advocacy, and technological innovations in milk production and processing.

ICAR-National Research Centre on Camel, Bikaner, Rajasthan

Participants will have the opportunity to visit the ICAR-National Research Centre on Camel in Bikaner, where they will explore camel dairy farming practices, research, and innovation.

Preparation for the Journey

You need to be mentally and physically prepared for this journey. You will be passing through a variety of physical and cultural landscapes. Please ensure you get regular exercise before the trip so that the strain of 15 days of travel is minimized, and your immune system remains strong. That said-don't over-prepare-it is an adventure, after all!

The most important thing to bring with you is an open mind and a willingness to learn and contribute. Yatra is an extremely complex logistical program, and things may not always go as planned. Delays, cancellations, and breakdowns might occur, and your attitude in dealing with these challenges will determine how well we can adapt and make the most of the situations we face. Remember, the journey itself-with all its ups and downs-is as meaningful as the destinations we visit.

Clothing and Essentials

Comfort and convenience take priority over style. **Based on our experience, we suggest the following:**

- Business Casuals
- T-Shirts / Tops
- Jeans / Comfortable trousers
- Salwar Kameez (for women)
- Socks
- Nightwear
- Comfortable walking shoes, slippers, chappals for train
- Cap and Sunglasses
- Towels
- Mobile Charger
- Underclothing
- Water Bottle (Mandate)
- **Toiletries:** Toothpaste, toothbrush, hairbrush/comb, sunscreen (if needed), soap, deodorant, shampoo
- Sanitary products (for females), wrapping paper for sanitary napkins
- Torch / Flashlight (Optional)
- Insect Spray / Mosquito Repellent (Optional)
- Sweater / Warm jacket (Optional)

Weather

As we will be traveling across various parts of India, expect different weather conditions. While we are journeying in the pleasant Summer season, regions in Western India.

Please pack accordingly for different weather scenarios-heat, cold, and rain-especially in terms of clothing, medical supplies, and footwear. Checking weather forecasts for the regions we'll visit is advised.

Please Note

- Do not forget your prescribed medications if you are under any treatment.
- Avoid bringing expensive items, high-value items, and jewelry.
- The management will not be responsible for the loss of any personal belongings.

Food and Beverages

Breakfast, lunch, and dinner will be provided during the journey. All meals will be basic, hygienic, and vegetarian. Please avoid bringing perishable food items. Dry snacks such as biscuits, dry fruits, and nuts are permitted.

Documentation

As the Indian proverb says, "Writing is lighter than memory," emphasizing that written records are more reliable than memory. This journey promises to be a once-in-a-lifetime experience, and we strongly encourage you to document each day-whether through journaling, sketching, or photography.

We appreciate your cooperation throughout the journey! Looking forward to an immersive learning experience on climate-smart dairy practices!!

If you need any clarifications or support during the journey,
please reach out to
97891 00200 / 91594 60001